



CLOUD VALUE LAB

A partnership to automate, professionalize, and scale your platform

Prepared for David May

David — great conversation recently with both of us. Your vision for Cloud Value Lab is clear, the market opportunity is real, and your content is genuinely differentiated. The constraint is execution: building an operation that runs without requiring your direct involvement as your time becomes more constrained.

Before putting this together, we did our homework on your space. What we found confirmed what you already know — but puts some numbers behind it.

The Market Right Now

\$44.5B

in annual cloud waste sitting on the table

\$15B → \$27B

FinOps market by 2030 (12.6% CAGR)

35K → 100K

practitioner community within 3 years

31% → 98%

AI cost management adoption (2024–2026)

This is a category in formation. The practitioners are multiplying, the budgets are growing, and AI is rewriting the playbook — but there is no independent, vendor-

neutral media platform serving this audience at scale. That's the gap Cloud Value Lab was built to fill.

THE SHIFT

Your Week: Before and After

YOUR WEEK NOW

- Record and schedule expert interviews
- Manually transcribe and edit into articles
- Write social posts for each platform
- Format and send the newsletter
- Clip video highlights by hand
- Track what's working, what's not
- Manage the website and archive

YOUR WEEK AFTER PHASE 2

- Record expert interviews
- Review final drafts (15 min)
- Everything else is automated

The result: You go from 15–20 hours per week of production work to under 2 hours. Your time shifts entirely to relationships, interviews, and strategic decisions — the things only you can do.

YOUR MARKET

Where Cloud Value Lab Stands

The FinOps media landscape has a handful of established players — but a clear window for the kind of independent, vendor-neutral, expert-level platform you're building. The practitioner community stands at 35,000 professionals, on track to hit 100,000 within three years. Despite all of that, the media landscape serving this audience is almost comically thin. Here's what we're seeing:

FinOps Foundation

INDUSTRY STANDARDS BODY

95K community **25.8K** LinkedIn

Certifications & events. Institutional player — sets standards and runs conferences. Not a content competitor today, but they define the ecosystem vocabulary and could move into media. Their audience is your audience. Speed matters.

FinOps Weekly / SmartClouds

CLOSEST DIRECT COMPETITOR

~6,500 subscribers **12K** LinkedIn

Vendor-sponsored. Run by a Madrid-based marketing agency whose clients are FinOps vendors. Content is curated links, not original thought leadership. Revenue comes from sponsorships and vendor webinars. FinOps X 2025 had 60+ sponsors and 2,000+ attendees — confirming the sponsorship economy is real. This is the model to beat, and your content already outclasses theirs.

Corey Quinn / Last Week in AWS

DOMINANT PERSONAL BRAND

100K+ Twitter **30K+** newsletter **669** podcast episodes

Massive following but AWS-only. Not multi-cloud FinOps, not a community. His company (Duckbill Group) raised \$7.75M to pivot to software. He's moved away from content — leaving an even bigger opening for a multi-cloud, practitioner-first voice.

Vendor Content Arms

INDIRECT COMPETITORS

CloudZero, Vantage, Apptio

Well-funded. Free content. FinOps tooling companies producing blogs, podcasts, and benchmarking reports as marketing. The tooling landscape has exploded from 5 tools to 115+, and consolidation is accelerating — Flexera alone acquired Spot, ProsperOps, and Chaos Genius in the past 14 months. Practitioners are increasingly skeptical of vendor-produced content. CVL's independence is the differentiator they can never match.

Cloud Value Lab

YOUR POSITION TODAY

~1,000 subscribers **Organic** growth **10%** week-on-week

Vendor-neutral. Expert-level interviews. Original content. The differentiators are real — but the infrastructure (site, social presence, content automation, SEO) isn't matching the quality of what you're producing.

The window: The largest FinOps newsletter has only 6,500 subscribers in a discipline that touches 97 of the Fortune 100. There is no Stratechery for FinOps — no independent, editorially-driven, vendor-neutral platform at the senior practitioner level. There is a 12–18 month window to become the default independent voice in this space before better-funded players notice. At your current growth rate, you reach 5,000 subscribers in four months and overtake FinOps Weekly in six. The investment isn't in content — your content is already better. The investment is in velocity.

THE AI MOMENT

There is a once-in-a-generation content gap opening right now. AI cost management went from **31% of organizations tracking it in 2024 → 98% in 2026** — the fastest adoption curve in FinOps history. GPU clusters run idle 15–30% of the time. Token-level cost attribution, model routing economics, and AI ROI framing for executives are skills every senior practitioner needs — and almost no content covers them with real depth.

The FinOps Foundation launched a dedicated "FinOps for AI" certification track. The tooling vendors are scrambling. But there is no independent editorial voice that practitioners trust to cut through the noise. **Cloud Value Lab can own this conversation before anyone else does.**

REVENUE POTENTIAL

What This Produces Financially

Newsletter Revenue (Base Layer)

At 5,000 subscribers with 2 sponsors per newsletter at \$30–\$75 CPM (standard for premium B2B tech verticals):

- ~\$300–\$750 per send
- Weekly distribution → \$1,200–\$3,000 per month

- Annualized → \$14,400–\$36,000

Where the Real Revenue Lives

Newsletter sponsorship is the base layer — predictable, growing with subscriber count. But in comparable B2B media platforms, 70%+ of total revenue comes from the layers above it:

- Enterprise sponsorship packages → \$15,000–\$75,000 per year each
- Premium membership tier → gated deep-dive reports, benchmarking data, and peer roundtables
- Virtual summits and sponsored roundtables → \$25,000–\$200,000 per event
- FinOps job board — practitioners earn \$100K–\$160K+; specialized boards charge \$500–\$2,500 per posting
- Original research reports — State of FinOps-style benchmarking, co-sponsored at \$10,000–\$50,000 per report

Conclusion: A properly executed platform reaches **\$100K–\$300K+ annually** before reaching true scale. Comparable B2B media communities — Exit Five, The Pragmatic Engineer — have built \$1M–\$3M+ ARR on these models with audiences your size or smaller. The investment to get there: \$4,000 + \$2,500/month.

THE PLAN

What We'll Build Together

PHASE 1

Foundation

Platform & Positioning

Before building anything new, we need to establish CVL as a standalone, professional platform — separate from your consulting site, with proper security, analytics, and SEO

architecture. This is the baseline that earns trust from the senior practitioners you're targeting. Your content is already better than the competition. Your site needs to match.

- Competitive analysis and positioning strategy — where CVL fits in the FinOps landscape and how to differentiate
- We will build a standalone CVL website — separate from your consulting site, purpose-built for content and community
- HTTPS / SSL implementation — basic credibility your current site is missing
- Google Analytics with engagement tracking — know who's reading, what they care about, and where they drop off
- Site-level SEO architecture — metadata, cross-linking, sitemap, structured data so search engines find you
- Social media audit — current presence vs. competitors, platform gaps, and a roadmap to close the distance

Phase 1 Deliverable

A live, SEO-optimized Cloud Value Lab platform with your existing content migrated, indexed, and searchable — ready for the content engine to run on top of.

PHASE 2

Automation

CMS, Content Engine & Distribution

The centerpiece of Phase 2 is a purpose-built CMS for Cloud Value Lab — your own platform to publish, manage, and organize all content without depending on third-party tools. Built on top of that is the automation layer that turns an interview transcript into a published, optimized article distributed across your channels, with your 15-minute review before anything goes live.

- **Custom CMS** — purpose-built content management system for CVL: publish articles, manage episodes, control layout, and own your data end-to-end
- **Social media publishing engine** — schedule and distribute content across LinkedIn, Facebook, Instagram, TikTok, WhatsApp, and any other platform of your choice

- We will build AI skills and agents to handle the full content workflow — from interview transcript to edited, SEO-optimized, published article, and automatic extraction of the best 60-90 second video or audio clips for social media
- Integrate an email marketing platform for newsletters and promotions — automated subscriber communications, new article alerts, and digest format
- Text messaging — reach your audience directly with alerts, promotions, and updates via SMS
- CRM integration — connect your contact management, track relationships, and tie audience growth to business opportunities
- Ongoing SEO optimization — every piece of content is optimized before it goes live
- AI-powered administration — the operation runs with minimal hands-on time from you
- Content archive system — organized, searchable, tagged library of your expert interviews and articles

How the Content Pipeline Works

1

YOU

Record an expert interview or provide raw content input

2

BOGEN.AI

AI pipeline produces article, social posts, video clips, and newsletter edition

3

YOU

15-minute review of final drafts. Approve, and everything publishes automatically

What Gets Produced Each Week

From a single interview or content input:

CONTENT OUTPUT

- 1 fully edited, SEO-optimized long-form article
- 3–5 short-form posts (LinkedIn, Facebook, Instagram, TikTok)
- 1–2 video or audio clips (60–90 seconds)
- 1 newsletter-ready formatted edition

OPERATIONAL OUTPUT

- Automated distribution across all channels
- Weekly publishing cadence (1–2 pieces minimum)
- Monthly performance report

- Fully organized, searchable content archive

Result: Consistent, expert-reviewed output without manual production effort.

EXECUTION

First 90 Days

WEEKS 1-2

- Platform build (site, analytics, SEO foundation)
- Positioning finalized
- Content structure and archive migration

WEEKS 3-4

- CMS + automation layer deployed
- First content pipeline activated
- Initial distribution channels connected

MONTH 2

- Consistent weekly publishing cadence established
- Content repurposing fully automated
- Audience growth tracking live

MONTH 3

- Optimization phase (SEO + engagement improvements)
- Monetization readiness (sponsorship structure, media kit)

Outcome by Day 90: A functioning, self-sustaining content and distribution engine — producing weekly without your hands on the keyboard.

On the Horizon: Monetization Roadmap

Once CVL has consistent content flow and a growing subscriber base, the revenue model builds naturally. B2B tech niche newsletters command \$50–\$150+ CPM — and the FinOps vendor landscape has 60+ active sponsors, flush with capital, who need practitioner mindshare. You build the audience, the economics follow. When you're ready, we'll build:

- Vendor sponsorships — annual packages across newsletter, site, and social; comparable platforms charge \$15K–\$75K+ per sponsor per year
- Premium membership tier — gated deep-dive reports, benchmarking data, and peer roundtables (\$49–\$299/month individual, enterprise annual plans)
- Virtual summits and sponsored roundtables — FinOps X drew 60+ sponsors at 2,000+ attendees; a CVL-branded event is a natural extension
- FinOps job board — practitioners earn \$100K–\$160K+; specialized B2B job boards charge \$500–\$2,500 per posting
- Original research reports — State of FinOps-style benchmarking, co-sponsored by vendors at \$10K–\$50K per report
- Subscription management and billing infrastructure

We'll revisit scope and pricing together when CVL reaches that stage. No surprises.

Why Bogen.ai

We build and operate this exact AI-driven content infrastructure internally — for our own publishing, our clients' platforms, and our weekly distribution systems. This is not theoretical. The system we're proposing for CVL is the same system we run every day.

Our current publishing operation produces weekly market intelligence packages, long-form articles, social content, and automated email distribution for multiple clients — all built on the same AI-first pipeline we'll deploy for Cloud Value Lab. We're not selling a concept. We're replicating a working system.

INVESTMENT

Phase 1 — Foundation

~~\$8,000~~

Platform build, positioning, SEO, analytics, content migration, and infrastructure

\$4,000 Founding partner pricing

Phase 2 — CMS, Content Engine & Distribution

~~\$5,000 /mo~~

Automation, CMS, publishing pipeline, newsletter, SMS, CRM, SEO, video clips, and ongoing optimization

\$2,500 /mo

FOUNDING PARTNER PRICING — 6-MONTH COMMITMENT

Founding partner terms: This rate is locked for 12 months from the start of Phase 2. After 12 months, pricing reverts to standard rates unless renewed.

Commitment: Phase 2 requires a 6-month initial commitment. After the initial term, continuation is month-to-month.

As scope expands into monetization systems, events, and advanced infrastructure, pricing will be revisited accordingly. This is a partnership — we want it to work for both sides long-term.

For context: comparable services from a mid-size digital agency typically run **\$15,000–\$30,000** for platform setup alone, with ongoing content and distribution retainers of **\$5,000–\$15,000 per month**. We're able to deliver at this price point because of our AI-first approach — the same automation we're building for you is how we operate.

Execution Guarantee

If Phase 1 is not completed within 30 days, work continues at no additional cost until delivery is complete.

If at any point during the 6-month commitment the weekly output falls below the deliverables outlined above for two consecutive weeks, you may exit the agreement with no penalty.

See It Before You Commit

Before any money changes hands, we'll run your pipeline on a real piece of content. Send us one interview transcript, and we'll produce the full output: article, social posts, video

clips, and newsletter edition. You'll see exactly what the system produces and how it handles FinOps-level content.

If the output meets your standard, we move forward. If not, we part ways with no cost and no hard feelings.

Next Step

Let's get on a call this week. We'll walk through this proposal together, answer any questions, and — if you're ready — pick a transcript for the pilot piece so you can see the output firsthand.

The FinOps category is forming in real time. The tooling landscape is consolidating, AI costs have created urgency that wasn't there 18 months ago, and practitioners are increasingly skeptical of vendor-produced content. The first credible, vendor-neutral platform at scale will capture disproportionate attention and sponsorship dollars — and right now, that lane is open. The infrastructure gap is the only thing between Cloud Value Lab and category ownership.

If aligned on the call, we begin Phase 1 immediately.

Looking forward to it, David.

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